

Copilot Licensing & Deployment

Field cheat sheet: who gets what, what it costs, and how to roll out without overwhelming the team.

THE MODEL

Copilot Chat

Web-grounded, safe to give broadly

Free, included

Microsoft 365 Copilot

Grounds on your data, zero-rates most agents

~\$30/user/mo*

Cowork & agents

On a paid seat, admin turns it on

Usage-billed

No "Premium" SKU: it is a label for the paid seat.

THE ONE BUDGET FACT

Paid seats make most employee-facing agent use free. Free-Chat users pay per interaction (~\$0.01/credit).

GOVERN FIRST (STEP ZERO)

- People:** committee, exec sponsor, champions, culture from the top
- Platform:** SharePoint Advanced Mgmt (included) + RCD, Purview, Agent Registry
- Rule:** let a governed few build, let everyone use approved agents

WHO GETS WHAT, BY ROLE

ROLE	TIER	EXTRA
Director / Exec	Paid seat	Cowork
Manager	Paid seat	Cowork
Analyst	Paid seat	Cowork, Studio
Knowledge worker	Start free → paid	Paid seat
Engineer / Dev	GitHub Copilot +seat	Studio, Azure
Frontline (F-plan)	Free Chat	Add-on F1/F3
Security / Compliance	Security Copilot	Per terms

AGENTS: BUILD → USE → GOVERN

- Build:** Agent Builder (biz), Copilot Studio (IT), Foundry (dev)
- Use:** paid seat = full & mostly free; free Chat = metered
- Govern:** Agent Registry + DLP + Purview, Agent 365 as you scale

THREE DATED ITEMS

- Jul 24

OpenAI models on by default; lack HITRUST/SOC1/FedRAMP High — disable if needed
- Jul 31

Restricted SharePoint Search blocked; move to RCD
- Now

Anthropic (Cowork/Researcher) outside EU boundary; confirm BAA

BAA covers Copilot + Chat. Web search is the exception — keep PHI out.

DO THIS NEXT

- Stand up the AI governance committee
- Turn on free Chat (handle web search for PHI groups)
- Buy a focused block of paid seats (dozens)
- Fix oversharing + stand up the Agent Registry
- Handle the three dated items (Jul 24 first)